

CRAFTROOTS

Product Requirements Document

Where travelers become makers, and artisans become hosts.

Version 1.0 | May 30, 2026 | Concept Stage

TABLE OF CONTENTS

- 1. Executive Summary
 - 1.1 Vision
 - 1.2 Mission
 - 1.3 Problem Statement
 - 1.4 Solution Overview
- 2. Target Audiences & Personas
 - 2.1 Primary User Segments
 - 2.2 Key Personas
- 3. Competitive Landscape
 - 3.1 Competitive Positioning Matrix
 - 3.2 Key Insights
- 4. Product Scope & Features
 - 4.1 Traveler Side Features
 - 4.2 Artisan Side Features
- 5. User Journey Map
- 6. Technical Requirements
 - 6.1 Technology Stack
 - 6.2 Non-Functional Requirements
- 7. Business Model & Unit Economics
- 8. Go-To-Market Strategy
- 9. Risk Analysis & Mitigation
- 10. Success Metrics & KPIs
- 11. Product Roadmap
- 12. Appendix

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.1 Vision

CraftRoots is the single platform that connects India's 64 lakh artisans with domestic and international travelers seeking authentic, hands-on craft experiences. We transform traditional workshops into bookable, immersive learning sessions — turning passive sightseeing into active participation, and product-dependent artisans into experience hosts.

1.2 Mission

To build the missing infrastructure between curious travelers and skilled artisans at scale — across every major craft tradition and travel destination in India — creating a living, bookable atlas of the country's living heritage.

1.3 Problem Statement

Across India, the same story repeats itself in hundreds of craft towns:

- Travelers arrive, glance at a workshop, buy a finished product at a bargained-down price, and leave — never knowing they could have sat down and made something themselves
- Artisans stand meters away from customers who would pay 5–10× more for an hour of hands-on learning than for a finished product on a shelf, but there is no platform to connect them, no trust layer to make booking feel safe, and no structured format to make the experience repeatable

The problem is not lack of demand and not lack of skill. It is a complete absence of infrastructure that turns the craft into an experience.

1.4 Solution Overview

CraftRoots creates the missing infrastructure by:

- For Travelers: Discovering verified craft experiences, booking in minutes, arriving at real working workshops, making something with their own hands, leaving with a self-made souvenir
- For Artisans: Earning 2–3× more per session than from product sales, gaining direct access to high-value customers for the first time, and being recognized as cultural hosts rather than commodity suppliers

2. TARGET AUDIENCES & PERSONAS

2.1 Primary User Segments

Segment	Description	Motivation	Pain Point
Domestic Weekend Travelers	Urban professionals (25–40) seeking unique getaways	Want authentic experiences, not tourist traps	Can't find hands-on craft workshops on mainstream platforms
International Cultural Tourists	Slow-travel advocates, journalists, researchers	Seek deep cultural immersion beyond surface tourism	No direct access to rural craft clusters; language barriers
Family Trip Planners	Organizers planning multi-generational heritage trips	Need age-inclusive, safe activities for parents and children	No information about accessibility, hygiene, or physical demands
Ethical Sourcing Professionals	Designers, buyers seeking authentic craft partnerships	Want to build direct, sustainable relationships with artisans	No reliable way to find authentic craft clusters; safety concerns
Rural Artisans	64 lakh skilled craftspeople across India	Want fair income without middlemen; pass on skills	No digital literacy; trapped in middleman-dependent product sales

2.2 Key Personas

Persona 1: Priya Sharma — The Urban Weekend Explorer

Age: 34 | Location: Bangalore | Role: UX Designer

About: Urban Professional, Weekend Explorer, Instagram Enthusiast

Motivations: Unique weekend getaways, authentic hands-on learning, content-worthy experiences

Goals: Book pottery in Khurja, learn block printing in Jaipur, find verified artisans

Pain Points: Can't find authentic experiences on MakeMyTrip; unsure about safety; last-minute planning stress

Technical Skills: Smartphone 95%, Online Booking 90%, Social Media 85%

Persona 2: Mark Thompson — The International Cultural Deep-Diver

Age: 42 | Location: London | Role: Travel Journalist

About: International Traveler, Cultural Writer, Slow Travel Advocate

Motivations: Research craft traditions for publication, understand techniques from masters

Goals: Document Warli painting, spend full days with blue pottery artisans

Pain Points: Mainstream tours are superficial; language barriers; verifying authenticity

Technical Skills: Smartphone 70%, Online Booking 85%, Social Media 60%

Persona 3: Ramesh Patel — The Artisan Host

Age: 58 | Location: Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Role: Kutch Embroidery Artisan

About: Master Craftsman, Rural Artisan, Family Breadwinner

Motivations: Fair income without middlemen, pass on skills, gain recognition as cultural host

Goals: Host 3–4 workshops/week, earn 2–3× more per session, build reputation

Pain Points: Middlemen pay only 20–30% of final price; no direct customer access; low digital literacy

Technical Skills: Smartphone 40%, Online Booking 20%, Social Media 15%

Persona 4: Ananya Reddy — The Family Heritage Trip Planner

Age: 28 | Location: Hyderabad | Role: Marketing Manager

About: Heritage Route Planner, Family Trip Organizer, Experience Collector

Motivations: Planning parents' 30th anniversary trip, meaningful family activities

Goals: Find age-inclusive Madhubani workshops, book Rajasthan route experiences

Pain Points: Difficult to find age-inclusive workshops; no accessibility info; hygiene uncertainty

Technical Skills: Smartphone 90%, Online Booking 85%, Travel Planning Apps 90%

Persona 5: Sofia Martinez — The Ethical Sourcing Professional

Age: 31 | Location: Barcelona | Role: Sustainable Fashion Designer

About: Ethical Sourcing Seeker, Craft Researcher, Solo Female Traveler

Motivations: Sourcing authentic crafts for fashion line, building ethical supply chains

Goals: Learn cane weaving in Assam, study Channapatna lacquerware, establish partnerships

Pain Points: No reliable way to find rural clusters; safety concerns; language barriers

Technical Skills: Smartphone 85%, Online Booking 90%, Travel Planning Apps 85%

3. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

3.1 Competitive Positioning Matrix

Competitor	Type	Artisan Direct?	Scalable?	Craft-Special ized?	Price Point	CraftRoots Differentiator
Airbnb Experiences	Experience Marketplace	Sometimes	Yes	No	\$37–50/session	Rural reach, artisan livelihood focus, curriculum design
MakeMyTrip/OTAs	Online Travel Agency	No	Yes	No	Variable	Experience-first, not destination-first
Luxury Tour Operators	Bespoke Tours	Sometimes	No	Partial	\$5,000+/trip	Accessible pricing, instant booking, no minimum spend
Dilli Haat	Physical Marketplace	Yes	No	Yes	Product prices	Experience economy, not product economy
Amazon Karigar/Thotfy	E-commerce Products	Yes (indirectly)	Yes	Yes	Product prices	Monetizes time, not inventory
Crafttours	Group Tour Operator	Yes	No	Yes	\$2,000+/tour	Individual booking, domestic market, no fixed itinerary
Government Portals	Policy Infrastructure	Yes	Yes (potential)	Yes	Free	Traveler-facing marketplace layer absent
CraftRoots	Experience Marketplace	Yes (verified)	Yes	Yes	■1,500–3,000/session	Artisan-first platform with loyalty, curriculum, and field onboarding

3.2 Key Insights

1. No one owns the 'bookable craft workshop' layer — Airbnb comes closest but lacks rural coverage and craft specialization
2. The artisan side is completely unserved — no platform treats artisans as hosts with profiles, dashboards, and loyalty incentives
3. Government initiatives are complementary — Tulip/Pehchan provide identity; CraftRoots provides income (potential partnership channel)
4. Domestic weekend travelers are ignored — all current craft experiences target international tourists or luxury travelers
5. Price arbitrage exists — luxury tours charge \$5,000+; Airbnb charges \$37; CraftRoots occupies the middle at ■1,500–3,000/session

4. PRODUCT SCOPE & FEATURES

4.1 Core Features — Traveler Side

4.1.1 Experience Discovery Engine

Feature	Description	Priority
Location-based Search	Browse experiences by city, town, or craft cluster	P0
Craft Type Filters	Filter by block printing, pottery, weaving, painting, etc.	P0
Duration Filters	2-hour, half-day, full-day, multi-day experiences	P0
Group Size Filters	Solo, couple, family, corporate group	P0
Price Range Slider	₹500–₹5,000+ per session	P0
Skill Level Tags	Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced	P1
Age Suitability	Family-friendly, adults-only, senior-accessible	P1
Real-time Availability	See open slots for next 7–30 days	P0

4.1.2 Verified Artisan Profiles

Feature	Description	Priority
Artisan Bio	Craft background, years of experience, family tradition	P0
Session Photos/Videos	Real workshop images, not stock photos	P0
Participant Reviews	Star ratings + detailed text reviews	P0
Trust Score	Composite score based on verification, reviews, completion rate	P0
Government ID Verification	Pehchan ID integration for credibility	P1
Video Introduction	Artisan introducing themselves in local language + subtitles	P1
Workshop Virtual Tour	360° or video walkthrough of actual workspace	P2

4.1.3 Seamless Booking & Payment

Feature	Description	Priority
Calendar Picker	Select date and time slot	P0
Group Size Selector	1–20 participants with dynamic pricing	P0
Secure In-app Payment	UPI (primary), cards, net banking, wallets	P0
Instant Confirmation	Email + SMS + WhatsApp confirmation	P0
Pre-session Guidance	What to wear, what to bring, how to reach, parking info	P0
Free Cancellation	Up to 24 hours before session	P0
Rescheduling	One free reschedule up to 12 hours before	P1
Gift Vouchers	Purchase session credits for friends/family	P2

4.1.4 Post-Session Engagement

Feature	Description	Priority
In-app Rating	1–5 stars + detailed review	P0
Photo Upload	Share photos of finished piece and workshop	P0
Social Sharing	One-tap Instagram/Facebook/WhatsApp sharing	P1
Loyalty Points	Earn points per booking, redeem for discounts	P1
Referral Code	Give ₹200, Get ₹200 for successful referrals	P1
Cross-city Recommendations	'Since you liked pottery, try blue pottery in Jaipur'	P1
Craft Route Builder	Plan multi-city craft itineraries	P2

4.2 Core Features — Artisan Side

4.2.1 Artisan Onboarding (Field Team Managed)

Feature	Description	Priority
Field Team Registration	Physical visit to artisan workshop for verification	P0
Profile Creation	Field team captures photos, videos, bio, craft details	P0
Curriculum Co-design	CraftRoots designs session structure with artisan input	P0
Training Session	How to host, teach, manage bookings, use dashboard	P0
Government ID Link	Integration with Pehchan/Tulip for verification	P1
Mystery Visit Program	Quality assurance checks by field team	P1

4.2.2 Artisan Dashboard

Feature	Description	Priority
Availability Calendar	Mark available dates and time slots	P0
Booking Management	View upcoming bookings, traveler details, group size	P0
Earnings Tracker	Real-time earnings, weekly/monthly summaries	P0
Payout System	Direct bank transfer within 48 hours of session	P0
Review Monitor	Read and respond to traveler reviews	P0
Loyalty Points View	See points earned, tier status, benefits unlocked	P1
Material Inventory	Track raw materials, request replenishment	P1
Performance Analytics	Booking rate, completion rate, average rating trends	P1

4.2.3 Artisan Loyalty Program

Feature	Description	Priority
Points Earning	Earn points based on traveler ratings and review quality	P1
Tier System	Bronze → Silver → Gold → Platinum based on points	P1
Visibility Boost	Higher tiers get better search placement	P1
Commission Reduction	Gold/Platinum artisans pay lower platform commission	P1
Priority Support	Dedicated WhatsApp support line for Gold/Platinum	P2
Tool/Equipment Grants	Access to better tools funded by platform	P2

5. USER JOURNEY MAP

Stage	Activities	Goals	Touchpoints	Experience	KPIs
Awareness	Hear about CraftRoots from friends, Instagram, travel blogs, Google search	Discover hands-on craft experiences as alternative to sightseeing	Word of mouth, Instagram ads, influencer posts, Google search, blogs	■ Curious: 'I didn't know I could learn block printing from a real artisan'	Reach, impressions, organic search visitors
Consideration	Browse artisan profiles, compare by craft type, duration, price, reviews	Find best workshop fitting schedule, budget, skill level; verify safety	CraftRoots app, artisan profiles, reviews, trust scores, WhatsApp support	■ Excited: 'So many options! Wish I could filter by beginner-friendly'	New visitors, pages/session, profile views, wishlist saves
Decision	Select date/time, complete payment, receive confirmation & pre-session guide	Book with confidence; know exactly what to bring and expect	Booking flow, calendar, UPI/cards payment, confirmation email/SMS	■ Anxious: 'Hope location is accurate and artisan shows up'	Cart value, conversion rate, payment success, abandonment
Pre-Session	Get reminders, use navigation, arrive at workshop, meet artisan host	Arrive safely; feel welcomed in artisan's real workspace	Push notifications, Google Maps, WhatsApp, workshop signboard, greeting	■ Relieved: 'Workshop smelled of real clay — not tourist setup'	On-time arrival, no-show rate, pre-session contacts
Workshop	2-4 hour hands-on session: carve block, throw pottery, weave, paint	Make something with own hands; understand cultural meaning; take souvenir home	Artisan instruction, materials, curriculum guide, chai break, finished piece	■■ PEAK: 'I'm actually doing it! Artisan is patient and proud'	Completion rate, satisfaction score, artisan rating, photo shares
Post-Session	Rate experience, write review, share on social, get loyalty points	Share experience; earn rewards; plan next craft adventure	In-app rating, social share prompts, referral code, loyalty notification	■ Happy: 'Want to share this — already want to book weaving in Assam'	Retention, referral rate, rebooking rate, NPS
Loyalty	Rebook, create blog/reel, recommend friends, gift vouchers	Build personal brand around ethical travel; help platform grow	Word of mouth, social posts, blog mentions, community forum	■ Satisfied: 'This is how tourism should work. Artisan earned 3x more'	Retention, rebooking, order value, community engagement
Advocacy	Give feedback, mentor new travelers, feel part of artisan community	See craft traditions thrive; know tourism creates real economic impact	Community events, artisan meetups, craft festivals, ambassador program	■ Proud: 'I'm part of something meaningful — future of travel'	Satisfaction, referral bookings, UGC volume, mission alignment

Experience Curve

Awareness: ■ Curious → Consideration: ■ Excited → Decision: ■ Anxious → Pre-Session: ■ Relieved → Workshop: ■■ PEAK → Post-Session: ■ Happy → Loyalty: ■ Satisfied → Advocacy: ■ Proud

6. TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

6.1 Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Mobile Apps	Flutter / React Native	Cross-platform iOS & Android
Web Frontend	Next.js / React	Responsive web app, SEO-optimized
Backend API	Node.js / Python (FastAPI)	RESTful & GraphQL APIs
Database	PostgreSQL	Primary transactional database
Cache	Redis	Session management, rate limiting
Search	Elasticsearch	Experience discovery, geo-search
Media Storage	AWS S3 + CloudFront CDN	Images, videos, documents
Payment Gateway	Razorpay	UPI, cards, net banking, wallets
Maps & Navigation	Google Maps API	Location services, directions
Notifications	Firebase + WhatsApp Business API	Push, SMS, WhatsApp
Analytics	Mixpanel + Amplitude	User behavior, funnel analysis
Monitoring	Datadog / New Relic	Performance, error tracking

6.2 Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Target
Availability	99.9% uptime
Latency	< 200ms API response time (p95)
Scalability	Support 10,000 concurrent users at launch; 100,000 by Year 2
Security	PCI-DSS compliant payment handling; GDPR-ready for international users
Localization	English + Hindi at launch; 8 regional languages by Year 2
Offline Support	Artisan dashboard works offline, syncs when connected

7. BUSINESS MODEL & UNIT ECONOMICS

7.1 Revenue Model

Component	Details
Commission per Booking	15–20% of session price (tiered by artisan loyalty level)
Payment Processing Fee	Pass-through (2% + GST) to travelers
Featured Listings	Optional paid boost for artisans (₹500/week for top search placement)
Corporate/Group Bookings	Custom pricing for 10+ participants
Subscription (Future)	'CraftRoots Plus' — unlimited bookings for ₹999/year

7.2 Unit Economics (Per Session)

Item	Amount (₹)
Traveler Pays	₹2,000 (average session price)
Platform Commission (18%)	₹360
Payment Gateway (2%)	₹40 (pass-through)
Net Revenue to Platform	₹360
Artisan Earns	₹1,600 (vs. ₹200–400 for equivalent product sale)
Artisan Earnings Multiple	4–8× vs. product sales

7.3 Launch Targets

Metric	Month 1–3	Month 4–6	Month 7–12
Artisans Onboarded	50 (2 cities)	150 (5 cities)	500 (15 cities)
Monthly Bookings	200	800	3,000
Gross Booking Value	₹4 lakh	₹16 lakh	₹60 lakh
Platform Revenue	₹72,000	₹2.88 lakh	₹10.8 lakh
Customer NPS	> 50	> 60	> 70
Artisan Retention	> 80%	> 85%	> 90%

8. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

8.1 Launch Sequence

Phase	Timeline	Focus	Cities
Phase 0: MVP	Month 1–2	Field team onboarding, 2 craft clusters, 50 artisans	Jaipur (block printing), Khurja (pottery)
Phase 1: Beta	Month 3–4	Private beta with 500 travelers, iterate on feedback	Same 2 cities
Phase 2: Public Launch	Month 5–6	Open to all, marketing push, PR	Add: Udaipur, Varanasi, Bangalore
Phase 3: Scale	Month 7–12	Field team expansion, 15 cities, 500 artisans	Add: Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune, Ahmedabad, Kochi, Guwahati, Jodhpur, Bikaner, Madurai
Phase 4: National	Year 2	All 28 states, 2–3 artisans per state minimum, 2,000+ artisans	Pan-India

8.2 Marketing Channels

Channel	Tactic	Budget Allocation
Instagram	Artisan reels, traveler testimonials, before/after stories	30%
Google Ads	'things to do in [city]', 'pottery workshop near me'	20%
Travel Bloggers	Sponsored content, hosted experiences, affiliate program	15%
Word of Mouth	Referral program, loyalty points for shares	15%
Corporate/Events	Team-building packages, school field trips	10%
PR & Partnerships	Government tie-ups (Tulip/Pehchan), craft festival presence	10%

9. RISK ANALYSIS & MITIGATION

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Artisan no-shows / poor quality	Medium	High	Field team verification, mystery visits, review system, artisan training program
Low traveler demand in rural areas	Medium	High	Start with high-traffic tourist cities (Jaipur, Varanasi); rural expansion only after proof of concept
Artisan digital literacy barriers	High	Medium	Field team manages all digital tasks; artisan dashboard simplified to WhatsApp-based interactions
Competitor response (Airbnb, OTAs)	Low	High	Build artisan loyalty through exclusive relationships; government partnerships as moat
Seasonality of craft tourism	High	Medium	Diversify across crafts and geographies; promote indoor crafts (weaving, painting) during monsoon
Payment fraud/chargebacks	Low	High	Razorpay fraud detection; hold period for new artisans; verified reviews before payout

10. SUCCESS METRICS & KPIs

10.1 North Star Metric

Monthly Active Bookings (MAB) — Number of completed sessions per month

10.2 Key Metrics Dashboard

Category	Metric	Target (Month 6)	Target (Year 1)
Growth	Monthly Active Bookings	800	3,000
Growth	Gross Booking Value	■16 lakh	■60 lakh
Growth	New Traveler Signups	2,000	10,000
Engagement	Sessions per Traveler (LTV)	1.5	2.5
Engagement	Average Session Rating	4.5★	4.7★
Engagement	Social Shares per Session	0.3	0.5
Artisan	Active Artisans	150	500
Artisan	Artisan Retention Rate	85%	90%
Artisan	Average Artisan Monthly Earnings	■12,000	■15,000
Financial	Platform Revenue	■2.88 lakh	■10.8 lakh
Financial	Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)	■800	■600
Financial	Lifetime Value (LTV)	■3,000	■5,000
Financial	LTV:CAC Ratio	3.75:1	8.3:1
Operations	Field Team Size	10	25
Operations	Cities Covered	5	15
Operations	Average Onboarding Time	3 days	2 days

11. PRODUCT ROADMAP

11.1 Q1 2026 (MVP Launch)

- Experience discovery engine (location, craft, price filters) — In Progress
- Artisan profile pages with photos and reviews — In Progress
- Booking flow with calendar and payment (UPI primary) — In Progress
- Field team app for artisan onboarding — In Progress
- Basic artisan dashboard (availability, bookings, earnings) — In Progress
- Pre-session guidance (email/SMS) — In Progress
- iOS and Android apps (MVP) — In Progress

11.2 Q2 2026 (Beta & Refinement)

- Review and rating system — Planned
- Loyalty points for travelers — Planned
- WhatsApp Business API integration — Planned
- Artisan loyalty tiers (Bronze/Silver/Gold/Platinum) — Planned
- Gift vouchers — Planned
- Corporate/group booking flow — Planned
- Web app launch — Planned

11.3 Q3–Q4 2026 (Scale)

- Cross-city craft route builder — Planned
- Subscription model (CraftRoots Plus) — Planned
- Community forum and events — Planned
- Ambassador program — Planned
- Government API integration (Tulip/Pehchan) — Planned
- Multi-language support (8 regional languages) — Planned
- Advanced analytics for artisans — Planned

11.4 2027+ (Platform Maturity)

- AI-powered experience recommendations — Future
- Virtual reality workshop previews — Future
- International payment and multi-currency — Future
- B2B marketplace (bulk craft orders for designers) — Future
- Craft education platform (online courses) — Future

12. APPENDIX

12.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Artisan Host	A skilled craftsperson who offers bookable, hands-on learning sessions to travelers
Craft Cluster	A geographic concentration of artisans practicing the same craft tradition (e.g., Khurja for pottery)
Experience Economy	Economic value derived from experiences rather than goods or services
Field Team	On-ground staff responsible for artisan onboarding, verification, and quality assurance
Loyalty Points	Gamified reward system for artisans based on traveler ratings and engagement
Mystery Visit	Unannounced quality check by field team posing as travelers
Pehchan ID	Government-issued artisan identity card under the Pehchan initiative
Trust Score	Composite rating based on verification status, review quality, and completion rate

12.2 Related Documents

- CraftRoots One Page Document
- User Personas & Empathy Maps
- Competitor Analysis
- Customer Journey Map
- Wireframes & Mockups (to be created)
- API Documentation (to be created)

Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	May 30, 2026	CraftRoots Product Team	Initial PRD

CraftRoots — Where travelers become makers, and artisans become hosts.